



1 CORINTHIANS 14:26-40

God Is Not a God of Confusion but of Peace

SERMON ANALYSIS



BIG IDEA (BLUF)

Christian worship is not about personal expression but about the orderly, loving, Christ-centered edification of the whole church. Every spiritual gift should strengthen others because God is a God of peace, order, and truth—not confusion.

PASSAGE OUTLINE

- I Every Gift Must Build Up the Church (vv.26-33a)**
 - Everyone may participate.
 - Every contribution should edify.
 - Tongues require interpretation.
 - Prophecy requires discernment.
 - Worship should be orderly because God is orderly.
- II Order Reflects God's Design (vv.33b-35)**
 - Application to husbands and wives in worship.
 - Questions handled in an orderly way.
- III Scripture Is the Final Authority (vv.36-38)**
 - Corinth does not define Christianity.
 - Apostolic teaching carries Christ's authority.
 - Refusing instruction shows spiritual immaturity.
- IV Pursue Gifts—Practice Order (vv.39-40)**
 - Desire prophecy. Do not forbid tongues.
 - Everything must be done properly and in good order.



VERSE-BY-VERSE PARAPHRASE

- 26 When you gather, everyone may bring something to contribute—but whatever is brought must strengthen the church rather than simply express yourself.
- 27 If someone speaks in tongues, limit the number of speakers and let them speak one at a time.
- 28 If no one can interpret the tongue, keep silent publicly and commune privately with God.
- 29 Allow two or three prophets to speak while the congregation carefully evaluates what is said.
- 30 If God gives another person a revelation, the current speaker should graciously yield the floor.

- 31 This orderly sharing allows everyone to learn and everyone to be encouraged.
- 32 True prophets remain in control of themselves; the Holy Spirit never overrides self-control.
- 33 God is not the author of confusion but of peace, and this principle governs every church.
- 34 The wives should not disrupt the gathered assembly but should respect the order God has established.
- 35 If they have questions, they should discuss them with their husbands afterward rather than interrupt corporate worship.

- 36 Did God's Word begin with you? Are you the only church that matters? Of course not.
- 37 If someone truly possesses spiritual maturity or prophetic gifting, they will recognize Paul's teaching as the Lord's command.
- 38 If someone refuses apostolic authority, that refusal exposes them.
- 39 Desire prophecy because it benefits the church, yet do not prohibit genuine speaking in tongues.
- 40 Everything in worship should be conducted honorably, appropriately, and in an orderly manner.

THEOLOGICAL THEMES



Corporate Worship Exists for Edification
The purpose of gathered worship is not personal experience but mutual strengthening.



Spiritual Gifts Serve the Body
No gift exists for self-promotion. Every gift is stewardship.



Order Reflects God's Character
Paul grounds church order in theology. Because God is orderly... His worship should reflect His nature.



Self-Control Is Evidence of the Spirit
The Spirit never removes responsibility. Spirit-filled people exercise self-control.



Apostolic Authority
Paul insists that his instructions carry Christ's authority. Submission to Scripture demonstrates submission to Christ.

GOSPEL FOCUS



Christ Himself builds His Church.
Jesus does not produce chaos.
He gathers sinners into one body.
He gives gifts. He appoints leaders.
He establishes peace through His cross.
Because Christ reconciles us to God,
we learn to live peacefully with one another.
The order of worship reflects the order
Christ has already accomplished
through the Gospel.

KINGDOM CONNECTIONS

The Kingdom of Christ advances not merely through gifted individuals but through an orderly church faithfully proclaiming His Word.

- ✓ God's Kingdom is not built by disorderly enthusiasm.
- ✓ Christ rules His church through His Word.
- ✓ Every believer has gifts for Kingdom service.
- ✓ Order magnifies the King's wisdom.
- ✓ Peaceful worship becomes a witness to unbelievers.
- ✓ Just as creation reflects God's order, so should His redeemed people.



APPLICATION GRID

How will I live this out?

AREA	WRONG RESPONSE	FAITHFUL RESPONSE
 Worship	"I want to express myself."	"How can I build others up?"
 Spiritual Gifts	Seek attention	Seek edification
 Teaching	Everyone speaks at once	Orderly participation
 Authority	Reject apostolic instruction	Submit to Scripture
 Self-Control	"The Spirit made me do it."	Exercise Spirit-enabled self-control
 Church Life	Confusion and competition	Peace and cooperation
 Marriage	Ignore God's created order	Honor God's design in worship
 Participation	Spectator	Faithful contributor

REFLECTION QUESTIONS



HEAD (Understand)

- Why does Paul repeatedly emphasize edification?
- What does orderly worship teach us about God's character?
- Why is not Paul connect worship practices to apostolic authority?



HEART (Examine)

- Do I seek recognition more than the good of others?
- Am I teachable under Scripture?
- Do I value peace more than personal preference?



HANDS (Apply)

- How can I use my gifts to strengthen my church this week?
- Am I contributing to peace or confusion?
- Where can I practice greater humility in corporate worship?

WITNESSING STATEMENT



"I've been reflecting with gratitude that God isn't a God of confusion. Through Jesus Christ, He brings peace, order, and truth into our lives, and He calls His people to build one another up rather than live for themselves."

INVITATION QUESTION



"Have you ever considered that the peace and order God desires in His church begin with being reconciled to Him through Jesus Christ?"

MEMORY VERSE

1 Corinthians 14:40 (NASB95)

"But all things must be done properly and in an orderly manner."



ONE-SENTENCE TAKEAWAY

Because God is a God of peace rather than confusion, every aspect of Christian worship should strengthen Christ's people through orderly, loving submission to His Word.